Minutes of Clinical Services Committee Meeting No. 9/2026

Hillward Counselling Service, Nan · Ref. HCS-CSC-09/2026 · Meeting held 24 September 2026 · Minutes approved for circulation 1 October 2026

Venue and time: Room 204, Hillward House, Nan town, 13:30–16:10.

Present: Dr. Siriporn Wongkham (Clinical Director, chair); Ratree Saengdao (Senior Counsellor and Safeguarding Lead); Pakorn Inthajak (Field Room Coordinator); Wilai Chaiyasit (Finance and Administration Manager); Duangporn Mahawong (Counsellor, adolescent team); Nattapong Sukjai (trainee counsellors' representative); Kanokwan Thammachak (Office Manager, minutes).

Apologies: Dr. Chalerm Boonprasert (visiting psychiatrist), who sent a written comment on item 6.

1. Previous minutes and matters arising

The minutes of Meeting No. 8/2026 (27 August 2026) were approved with one correction: item 4 should read that the evening clinic closes at 20:00, not 20:30.

2. Waiting list report

Kanokwan Thammachak reported 212 people on the waiting list on 19 September 2026, up from 168 at the end of June. The median wait from referral to first appointment is now 41 days for adults and 23 days for clients under 18, who keep priority. The service target remains 28 days for adults.

To shorten waits, the committee **agreed to open a Saturday single-session clinic** at Hillward House from 3 October 2026, 09:00–13:00, staffed by two qualified counsellors on a rota. Each Saturday offers 8 booked single sessions of 50 minutes. People on the waiting list are offered these slots first, in order of referral date. A single session does not remove a person from the waiting list unless they say they do not need further counselling.

> **Note.** The Saturday clinic is not a crisis service and does not take walk-in clients. People in crisis continue to use the Hillward duty phone, which is staffed 08:00–22:00 every day.

3. Hillward Field Room: pilot review and extension

Pakorn Inthajak presented the review of the Field Room pilot, the mobile counselling van that ran from 6 May to 28 August 2026. The van provided 94 counselling sessions to 51 clients; 19 of them were farm workers who said they could not travel to Nan town during the planting season.

The committee **agreed to continue the Field Room permanently and to add two districts**. The schedule from October 2026 is:

- Tha Wang Pha: first and third Tuesday of each month, car park of the Tha Wang Pha Morning Market, 10:00–16:00.
- Pua: second and fourth Wednesday of each month, beside the Pua district community hall, 10:00–16:00.

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- Chiang Klang: every Thursday from 5 November 2026, Wat Nong Bua Kham grounds, 11:00–16:00.
- Song Khwae: first Friday of each month from 4 December 2026, Song Khwae village meeting hall, 10:00–15:00.

Bookings are made through the Hillward office or by telephone the day before; up to two places per van day are kept for people who arrive without a booking. If the van cannot travel because of weather or a breakdown, the office calls all booked clients by 08:30 and offers a phone session at the same time.

4. Session fees from 1 October 2026

Wilai Chaiyasit presented the fee review. Until 30 September 2026 a standard individual session cost 600 baht. The committee **approved the following fees from 1 October 2026**:

- First assessment session (60 minutes): 300 baht.
- Standard individual session (50 minutes): 700 baht.
- Couple or family session (75 minutes): 1,100 baht.
- Reduced fee: 150 baht per session for students and for clients with a monthly household income below 12,000 baht, on showing a student card or completing the income declaration form FD-1.
- Saturday single sessions: 200 baht for everyone.

Field Room sessions remain free of charge until 31 December 2026, funded by the Nan Riverbend Community Fund grant. The committee will decide in December whether to charge the reduced fee in 2027. Clients already in a course of sessions before 1 October 2026 keep the old price of 600 baht until that course ends or until 31 January 2027, whichever is earlier.

A missed session without 24 hours' notice is charged at half the session fee. The charge is waived for a first missed session, for illness with any written note, and for any Field Room session.

5. Safety concerns during Field Room sessions

Ratree Saengdao reported one incident in July, when a client disclosed thoughts of ending his life at the end of a van session and the counsellor was unsure whom to contact. No harm occurred, but the committee agreed that the van needs a written procedure because it operates up to 80 km from Hillward House. The committee **adopted the following procedure**, effective immediately:

1. When a client shows signs of serious risk to self or others, the counsellor completes the short risk screen (form RS-2) with the client before the session ends.
2. If the screen shows high risk, the counsellor stays with the client, or makes sure another trusted adult does, and does not let the client leave the van alone.
3. The counsellor calls the Safeguarding Lead on the duty phone. If there is no answer within 10 minutes, the counsellor calls the Clinical Director.
4. The Safeguarding Lead or Clinical Director decides on the next step with the counsellor, such as a same-day appointment with Dr. Boonprasert, contacting family with the client's consent, or calling emergency services.
5. The counsellor writes up the event on incident form IF-3 within 24 hours, and the Safeguarding Lead phones the client within 48 hours to follow up.

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6. Clinical supervision and trainee counsellors

Nattapong Sukjai asked for clearer rules on trainee placements. The committee confirmed that trainee counsellors receive one hour of individual supervision for every six hours of client work, and qualified counsellors receive at least two hours of supervision per month. Supervision notes are kept by the supervisor, not in client records.

Trainees may work on the Field Room van only in a pair with a qualified counsellor who has at least two years of practice after qualification. A trainee must never see a client on the van alone, even for a short time; if the qualified partner is called away, the trainee pauses the session and waits. Trainees do not take Saturday single sessions, which are reserved for qualified counsellors. In his written comment, Dr. Boonprasert supported these limits and offered one case discussion per month for trainees, starting in November.

7. Client records from the van

The van has no reliable mobile signal in parts of Chiang Klang and Song Khwae, so session notes are sometimes written on paper. The committee agreed that paper notes are kept in the locked document box in the van and scanned into the client record system within two working days of the van day. The Office Manager checks each scan and then shreds the paper copy. Notes must not be stored on personal phones, and the van tablet must not keep offline copies of notes after the end of the van day.

8. Interpreters

Hmong and Mien interpreters from the Hillward interpreter list must be booked at least five working days before the session. Interpreters sign the confidentiality agreement every year. Family members may interpret only when no listed interpreter is available and the client asks for it in writing; a child under 16 may never interpret for a client, and a family member may never interpret in a session that concerns family violence.

9. Any other business

The service will close on Saturday 14 November 2026 for the annual staff wellbeing day; no Saturday clinic will run that day, and the duty phone will be covered by Ratree Saengdao.

10. Action points

- Publish the new fee list on the website and at reception by 30 September 2026: Wilai Chaiyasit.
- Print form RS-2 and the safety procedure for the van door card, and brief all van staff by 10 October 2026: Ratree Saengdao.
- Agree the Chiang Klang site with Wat Nong Bua Kham and announce the new schedule by 20 October 2026: Pakorn Inthajak.
- Set up the Saturday clinic rota for October to December: Dr. Siriporn Wongkham.
- Update the trainee placement handbook with the rules in item 6: Nattapong Sukjai with Duangporn Mahawong.

Next meeting: Thursday 29 October 2026, 13:30, Room 204, Hillward House.

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